Blurring the lines between the three extensions

Now, for an example of the degree of control that's allowed to a developer in the Firefox environment, we take a look at an extension that we mentioned earlier: 'Vimperator' – one which closely resembles the (much too) famous command line text editor, Vim. The concept behind the project is to provide a completely different experience to the user, in contrast to that provided by the vanilla Firefox installation. This means, every unnecessary element in the browser's chrome (chrome is defined as the UI elements in the browser, covering everything but the title bar and the page view area) is removed, and you get to view your page in full glory making the most of all of the screen's real estate. The only navigation and control section provided is a bar at the bottom of the screen which takes input in the form of pre-defined key bindings, many of which are replicated from Vim itself. While a regular user might find this daunting, the interface's accurate reflection of the original editor is comforting to a vast majority of its users, and is therefore one of the most widely used add-ons for the browser. Just like its command line counterpart, Vimperator is widely appreciated for reducing dependence on a mouse, while focusing almost all the necessary actions literally on a user's fingertips, via the key bindings.

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Gecko versus WebKit

Now, with that knowledge let's move forward. The next appropriate step would be to get a rough idea of the soul of the whole operation. We, therefore, look into the architecture of the browser engine under consideration – the Gecko engine. It's widely acknowledged that the rendering engine is the component most critical in the experience provided by a browser. If you've been watching the development scene closely, you would have definitely heard about the current buzzword on the horizon, 'WebKit' – which powers Apple's Safari browser and Google's Chrome browser. Now for a